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/ **Practice Exam - 1**

Correct Answer

Next Q

Practice Exam - 1

Question 42 of 117



A 65-year-old man presents to clinic for follow up. He has a seven-year history of nonischemic dilated HFrEF (25-30%) who presents earlier than planned with abdominal discomfort. The patient reports dull and diffuse stomachaches, nausea and vomiting that started 3 days prior. Patient's other medical history includes CRT-D placement for primary prevention, DM, HTN, HLD, obesity. He has been on stable doses of carvedilol 25mg twice daily, sacubitril/valsartan 49/51mg twice daily, spironolactone 25mg daily, furosemide 60mg daily, and rosuvastatin 40 nightly. About a week ago empagliflozin 10mg daily was added to medical therapy. On exam he appears uncomfortable. His blood pressure is 114/56 mm Hg, heart rate is 72 bpm, respiratory rate is 16/ min, and oxygen saturation rate is 99% while breathing ambient air. Orthostatic vital signs were normal. There is no appreciable JVD. His cardiovascular examination reveals normal rate, regular rhythm, with no murmurs or gallops heard. Lungs are clear, abdomen is soft, and distal extremities are warm to touch. Patient is sent to emergency department for further evaluation. Laboratory studies reveal sodium of 147 mEq/L, potassium of 4.4 mEq/L, glucose 106 mg/dL, urea nitrogen is 24 mg/dL and creatinine of 1.38 mg/dL. His electrocardiogram and chest X-ray are normal and transthoracic echocardiogram is unchanged from prior.

Which one of the following is the best next step in the management of this patient?

- A. Admit patient for evaluation of advanced HF therapies
- ☒ B. Obtain blood ketones and serum beta-hydroxybutyrate
- C. Obtain GI consult
- D. Admit for IV fluids

Commentary

References

Testing Point: SGLT2 inhibitors can precipitate euglycemic DKA

Answer: B. Obtain blood ketones including serum beta-hydroxybutyrate

Euglycemic DKA in a DM patient on SGLT2 inhibitors

Distractor 1 - Admit patient for evaluation of advanced HF therapies will be selected due to lack of knowledge of cardiogenic shock signs.

Distractor 2 - Obtain GI consult -- will be selected due to lack of knowledge of SGLT2 inhibitors adverse effects.

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